MEDICARE GUIDE PROGRAM

Medicare may pay for dementia respite care at home.

GUIDE is a Medicare program for people living with dementia at home. Most eligible families never hear it exists. Caring Companions is an approved GUIDE respite provider in southwest Missouri.

WHAT IT COVERS

Respite care

For families who meet Medicare's criteria

Twenty 4-hour visits a year, 80 hours, given by our caregivers and billed to Medicare rather than to you.

A care navigator

For every enrolled family

A trained person who calls every month with education, resources, and someone to talk to who has seen this before.

A 24/7 support line

For every enrolled family

Dementia doesn't keep business hours. Urgent questions and behavior nobody prepared you for, any hour of the night.

20 visits
four hours each, 80 hours a year, for families who meet Medicare's criteria

$0
GUIDE services are covered by Medicare, so there is no bill to you for them

July 1
hours reset every year and don't roll over, so it's best to use them steadily

WHO QUALIFIES

Two things decide most of it: the kind of Medicare, and where they live.

Usually fine

- Traditional or Original Medicare
- Living at home, alone or with family
- A house, apartment or condo
- Independent living, where care is not part of the lease
- Palliative care (this is not hospice)
- Having Medicaid or VA benefits as well

Rules it out

- A Medicare Advantage plan (Humana, Aetna, UnitedHealthcare, Anthem or any plan name)
- Assisted living, memory care, a group home, or board and care
- Living in a nursing home
- Enrolled in Medicare hospice or PACE
- No dementia or memory impairment diagnosis

Medicare changed the residence rule in June 2026. If someone told you last year that assisted living was fine, that is no longer true.

WHAT THIS IS REALLY FOR

Medicare built GUIDE for the three things that usually break first.

You are worn out

Respite is not a luxury, and it is not admitting defeat. It's the afternoon you get to see your own doctor, or just sleep.

Nobody told you what's next

The care navigator tells you what the next stage looks like, which paperwork matters, and which worries are worth your energy.

It's 2am and she won't settle

The 24/7 line exists for exactly that: a clinical line that can talk you through it, not an answering service.

HOW IT GOES FROM HERE

1

We talk

No cost and no obligation, at home or on the phone. We go over the eligibility questions and answer yours.

2

The assessment

We visit and complete a full assessment with you and your loved one, then submit it. Plan on two to three weeks for approval.

3

Care starts

Once enrollment is approved, we schedule respite visits around you, in 4-hour visits.

GOOD TO KNOW

Not every family gets the respite hours. Everyone accepted into GUIDE gets the care navigator and the 24/7 line. The respite hours go to families where the dementia has progressed to a certain stage and the caregiver carries a heavy load. Medicare measures both during the assessment.

If your loved one is early in the disease, they may be enrolled without respite hours at first and qualify later. We'll tell you honestly where you seem to stand before you commit to anything.

IS IT REALLY FREE?

GUIDE services are covered by Medicare, so there's no bill to you for them. It isn't unlimited care. The respite benefit is about twenty 4-hour visits a year. If you need more, the rest is regular private-pay care, and we'll tell you exactly what it costs first.

Does it replace their doctor? No. GUIDE adds a navigator and a support line alongside their current care team.

Check eligibility in two minutes

Call us and we'll go through the questions with you, or scan the code to check online. Nothing is sent to Medicare until you ask us to.

CALL ANY TIME
(417) 234-8494